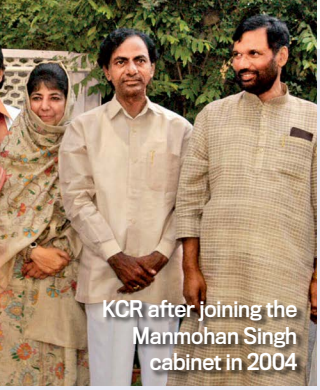


KCR after joining the Manmohan Singh cabinet in 2004

from Karimnagar and MLA from Siddipet; made Union minister of state for labour and employment in the Manmohan Singh cabinet

2006

Resigns from LS in September and sits on a hunger strike in Delhi to intensify the separate statehood agitation; re-elected to LS in a bypoll from the same constituency in December

2008

Resigns in March from LS; re-elected from the same constituency

2009

Elected to LS for a third time from Mahbubnagar; begins a fast unto death on November 29, demanding introduction of the Telangana Bill in Parliament that was withdrawn after the Union government's nod to separate statehood and a promise to merge TRS with the Congress

2014

Backtracks on the merger promise and steers TRS to be the largest party winning 63 of the 119 assembly seats; elected MLA from Gajwel and Medak, and to LS from Medak; resigns from the MP position; sworn in as the new state's first CM after its birth



During the formation of Telangana in 2014

on June 2; orders a state-wide intensive household survey to collate citizen information to roll out welfare programmes

2017

Declares Urdu as the second official language of Telangana

2018

Dissolves the assembly in September to call for an early election and delink assembly contest from parliamentary poll; wins with 88 seats and is re-elected CM

2019

Attempts to set up a Federal Front ahead of the May general election; wins nine LS seats



With son and minister KTR

and registers a landslide victory in local elections

2022

Renames TRS the Bharat Rashtra Samithi in October to develop a national footprint; opens its national office in Delhi in December

2023

Contesting for the Gajwel and Kamareddy assembly seats

DEFENDING THE STATE'S HIGH DEBT TO GDP RATIO, SON KTR SAYS TELANGANA'S INVESTMENTS ARE IN CRITICAL INFRASTRUCTURE LIKE POWER, IRRIGATION, HEALTH

2020. The PM also claimed that KRS told him that he planned to retire when he turned 70 and make his son K.T. Rama Rao (KTR) the chief minister. When asked about it in the interview, KCR charged the prime minister of "making up convenient stories" and stooping low to reveal private conversations for political gain. The BJP also accuses KCR of *parivarvaad* and nepotism. The party points out that KCR's son KTR is the party's working president and the industries minister, while daughter Kavitha is an MLC. Then there are nephews T. Harish Rao, who holds the health and finance portfolios; J. Santosh Kumar, a Rajya Sabha member who assists KCR; and K. Vamshidhar Rao, who was appointed BRS in-charge for Maharashtra in July. KCR charges the BJP with double standards and points to the recent elevation of B.Y. Vijayendra, son of former Karnataka CM B.S. Yediyurappa, as state BJP chief.

Meanwhile, BJP strongman Amit Shah announced that the party will appoint a CM from the backward classes if it won. This is part of the party's strategy to woo the 52 per cent OBC voters in the state. It also serves to highlight the contrast with KCR and Revanth's forward caste and feudal backgrounds. KCR is from the Velama community and Revanth is a Reddy. Shah's offer may hold some appeal as none of the Telugu states have had an OBC CM since Independence. To buttress its offer, the BJP has allotted 36 seats to OBC candidates, far higher than the 23 each the BRS and Congress have done. The BJP is also in the race for all seats for the Scheduled Castes and Tribes. At a recent rally in the state, Modi assured the Madigas, a dominant SC community in the state, that he will devise ways to break up the statutory reservations to enable them to get a fair share.

However, despite its burst of aggression, the BJP may find it difficult to displace the Congress as KCR's prime challenger. As elsewhere, the saffron party is banking on Modi's image and what the Centre has done for the state in Telangana as well. Yet several senior leaders, including state BJP chief Reddy, OBC Morcha chief K. Laxman, national vice president D.K. Aruna and the BJP Madhya Pradesh in-charge Muralidhar Rao, have opted out of the legislative assembly contest. This is despite the BJP Central Election Committee having decided earlier that all